Edwin Oduor Ong'aro

Software Engineer / Full Stack Web Developer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5 years of professional experience building and maintaining web applications and business systems using PHP/Laravel, Vue.js, JavaScript, and MySQL. Experienced in developing REST APIs, integrating third-party services, troubleshooting production systems, and improving application performance. Strong background in financial and operational systems, including HRMS and CRM platforms, with hands-on experience taking features from requirements through development, testing, deployment, and maintenance.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python
Backend: Laravel, REST APIs, FastAPI
Frontend: Vue.js, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Blade, Livewire
Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis
Testing: PHPUnit, Pest
Performance & Reliability: Query optimization, N+1 resolution, caching, performance profiling, debugging
Integration: REST APIs, M-Pesa, Banking APIs, KRA eTIMS, third-party services
DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), AWS, DigitalOcean, Linux, Nginx, Supervisor
Version Control: Git
AI-assisted Development: ChatGPT, Gemini

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Litsa Credits Ltd — Software Engineer

Nairobi, Kenya (Remote) | Apr 2026 – Present

- Designed, built, and deployed a Laravel/MySQL Human Resource Management System supporting 72 employees and core HR operations.
- Automated payroll workflows, reducing payroll processing time from 5 days to seconds.
- Developed and currently maintain a Laravel 13/Livewire CRM with M-Pesa payment integration, transaction reconciliation, reporting/export workflows, and queued customer SMS notifications.
- Implemented role-based access control, employee profiles, document management, attendance tracking, activity logs, and audit trails.

- Developed and maintained backend functionality across the HRMS and CRM using Laravel and MySQL, with focus on data integrity and system reliability.
- Handled production application operations including Linux/Nginx/PHP-FPM configuration and Supervisor-managed Laravel queue workers.
- Integrated the Sauti API into the Loan Management System to automate client updates on loan status, repayments, and collections for over 700 clients.
- Developed Autodater, reducing manual database querying and Google Sheets updates from 3 hours to 30 minutes, supporting 29 representatives and over 800 clients.
- Worked directly with business stakeholders to gather requirements, prioritize features, and improve operational workflows.
- Currently developing performance tracking and reporting modules for employee evaluation and management reporting.

Zendawa Africa — DevOps Engineer

Remote, Part-Time | Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Developed and maintained Laravel backend features including wallet, vouchers, loyalty points, telemedicine, and delivery tracking modules.
- Built RESTful APIs consumed by a Flutter mobile application.
- Integrated M-Pesa payment services supporting 1,000+ daily transactions.
- Implemented Redis-backed caching and application optimizations to improve performance.
- Built CI/CD pipelines using Docker and GitHub Actions for automated testing and deployment.
- Deployed and managed applications on AWS infrastructure including EC2, RDS, and Elastic Beanstalk.
- Participated in code reviews and mentored junior developers on Laravel development and clean coding practices.

ICORE Information Systems — Backend Developer

Nairobi, Kenya (Remote) | Jan 2024 – Jun 2025

- Developed and maintained Laravel-based ERP and POS systems used by multiple business clients.
- Designed and implemented REST APIs for banking integrations, processing real-time financial transaction notifications with latency below 200ms.
- Diagnosed and resolved application performance issues, including N+1 queries, inefficient database queries, and caching opportunities.
- Improved system response time by approximately 50% through database and application-level optimizations.

- Built financial reporting systems including profit/loss reports, transaction analytics, and operational dashboards.
- Collaborated with frontend developers using Vue.js and Blade to deliver complete application features.
- Worked within Agile development workflows including sprint planning, daily standups, and iterative delivery.
- Wrote automated tests using PHPUnit and Pest to improve application reliability and maintainability.

Conrad Resort — Web Developer

Apr 2023 – Aug 2023

- Built a hotel booking and content management system using Laravel, MySQL, and Bootstrap.
- Implemented backend business logic, database design, and frontend integration.

ICORE Information Systems — Software Developer & IT Support

Aug 2021 – Aug 2022

- Maintained production Laravel applications and Linux servers.
- Diagnosed and resolved backend issues affecting application performance and client operations.
- Assisted with feature development, bug fixes, and ongoing system maintenance.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Bank Integration REST API System

Technologies: Laravel, MySQL, REST APIs

- Built a secure REST API for processing real-time bank transaction notifications.

OASMS Management Platform

Technologies: Laravel, Livewire 3, Volt, Redis, Tailwind CSS

- Developed backend services, caching strategies, and reporting modules for an outdoor advertising management system.

Laravel Mini LMS

Technologies: Laravel 13, Vue, MySQL

- Implemented a mini loan management system covering users, customers, and loans and the latter’s disbursal and notifications.

Litsa CRM

Technologies: Laravel 13, Livewire 4, PowerGrid, MySQL, M-Pesa

- Developed CRM functionality for customer and device management, payment processing and reconciliation, date-filtered transaction exports, and queued SMS notifications.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

Laikipia University, Kenya

REFERENCES

Available on request.